

Adversarial Collaboration

Lab sheet for students

When is the last time you changed your mind? Or confronted someone with a different opinion without ending up in a horrible argument? It seems like in the age of spectacle politics and social media bubbles, we're slowly losing the art of debating. Fear not – during this session, you will have a chance to read in-depth about a new topic, gain public speaking skills and learn how to listen. Most importantly, all done in friendly environment and small groups.

On 22nd Oct, you will be assigned into a team debating a contentious security & privacy topic. We cannot reveal the topics or the teams in advance, but we can assure you that this exercise will help you to put yourself in someone else's shoes and, who knows, maybe you will change your mind in the end?

On 5th Nov, you will present the result of your team work to your course mates.

The next two sessions will help you with building team working, listening, persuasion skills. By the end of the class, you will achieve a better understanding of the connections between security, surveillance, crime, and politics.



1. Session one: Preparation (22nd Oct 1100 – 1300)

You will work in small groups and a Teaching Assistant (TA), who will be there to help you with any questions!

During this session you will:

- Discuss how to debate and collaborate well
- Receive some tips on public speaking
- Be introduced to the format and topic of the event
- Will be assigned into teams

- Brainstorm how to approach the topic

2. Homework

- Everyone in each team individually reads around the topic and makes decent notes outlining arguments in favour of their own opinions as well as additional questions for the opponent's side
- Each team needs to prepare a 5 mins spoken presentation and a slide deck for the 5th of Nov session.
- The presentations must include: 1) arguments for 2) arguments against 3) how did you change your minds over the course of the exercise? 4) where do your opinions differ and why? 5) can you reach a common conclusion?
- Please email your slides to your TA ahead of the 5th of Nov session
- Apart from presenting, students will also be required to be active participants in Q&A sessions. Therefore, please prepare a handful of questions to ask during your course mates' presentations in advance
- You are encouraged to set up an independent meeting with your team mate to discuss strategy of your team and progress-to-date.

3. Session two: Presentations (5th Nov 1100 – 1300)

In this session, each pair will present their slides followed by 5 mins Q&A between every presentation.

4. General advice

- Reading: Try to include a wide variety of sources within your team (different news outlets, various blogs, research articles)
- Please work collaboratively and split your tasks as fairly as possible!
- Speaking style: There is no single winning formula for a convincing presentation. Use a good mix of solid evidence, calm manner, and sharp humour, with a dash of your own personality. Take inspiration from top public speakers! I personally recommend PhilosophyTube YouTube channel ☺ <https://www.youtube.com/user/thephilosophytube>
- What to avoid: keep negative emotions at bay and do not make any insulting remarks about your opponent!
- Three simple steps to making a good argument: 1) Say **what your argument is**. 2) Explain why your argument is **true**. 3) Explain why your argument is **important**
- In order to avoid arguing about semantics, you need to agree on key definitions early as a team and present them in your introduction speech!

5. Useful resources on debating skills

- Introduction to Adversarial Collaboration: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sW5sMgGo7dw&ab_channel=BigThink
- Tips on a successful adversarial collaboration: <https://daphnemartschenko.com/adversarial-collaboration/>
- Introduction to logical fallacies: <https://yourlogicalfallacyis.com/>
- Video with tips for confidence building in debating https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cry_rcxSiCc
- Tips on influencing people and winning an argument <https://www.theguardian.com/science/2019/jun/30/the-science-of-influencing-people-six-ways-to-win-an-argument>
- Types of rebuttal statements: https://www.dav.com.au/resources/rebutting_an_argument.php